

THE MACHINE CAN MIX NOW.

SO WHAT'S LEFT FOR YOU?

A short playbook on the AI tools reshaping DJing —
and the moves that keep you irreplaceable.

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ONE HONEST NOTE

This is a working playbook, not a prediction. The AI tools listed are shipped and current as of publication. The tools will change fast. The four moves are designed to survive whatever ships next.

SECTION 01

THE TOOL STACK.

What's actually shipped, what's genuinely useful, and what to ignore. Not sponsored. Not comprehensive. Just honest.

USE THESE · THE COPILOTS WORTH LEARNING

SERATO STEMS / VIRTUALDJ NEURAL / ALGORIDDIM NEURAL MIX

Real-time stem separation. Isolate vocals, drums, bass from any track live.

→ Free bandwidth for creative choices. Frees you from being a technician.

USE WITH INTENTION · POWERFUL BUT RISKY

PULSEDJ

AI copilot that suggests your next track in real time based on set flow.

→ Useful for library discovery. Dangerous if it starts making your creative calls.

DJ.STUDIO

AI-assisted timeline mixing. Automates portions of the mix itself.

→ Great for recorded mixes and podcasts. Not a live-set replacement.

KNOW THEY EXIST · WHAT'S RESHAPING THE INDUSTRY

TUNEE AI

Generates full Bollywood wedding tracks — dhol, brass, Hindi vocals — cleared for commercial use.

→ Wedding DJs in India: this is your direct competition. Plan accordingly.

SUNO / UDIO

Generates complete songs from text prompts. Producer-free music.

→ The floor of what's possible without a human is rising monthly. Track it.

NOTE

None of these companies paid for inclusion. Tool availability shifts monthly — verify current versions before committing time or money to any of them. This list is a starting point, not a buying guide.

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SECTION 02

THE FOUR MOVES.

The tools will change. The stack you use in three years won't be the stack today. These four moves are designed to survive whatever ships next.

01 STOP COMPETING ON TECHNICAL SKILL

This one is uncomfortable but non-negotiable. Beatmatching, key-matching, level-riding, clean transitions — all of it is being commoditised at speed. Being technically clean is now the floor of the profession, not the ceiling. It's what you're expected to have, not what makes you notable.

THE MOVE: Move your practice hours away from technique drills and toward taste development. Buy more music. Listen to more genres. Study why one track works next to another. That's the muscle worth building.

02 BUILD YOUR POINT OF VIEW OUT LOUD

AI has no point of view. It has patterns, taste-averages, and probability distributions. What it doesn't have is a specific human with a specific history telling you why they play what they play.

THE MOVE: Post your sets with a paragraph on what you were trying to do. Write about the tracks that shaped you. Talk about the ones you played that didn't work. Make your reasoning visible. That's the thing an algorithm cannot mimic.

03 DEVELOP ONE THING NO ALGORITHM WOULD SUGGEST

A signature edit. A genre bridge nobody else makes. A curatorial choice a recommendation engine would flag as anomalous. One specific move that is yours.

THE MOVE: This is your moat. Not because it's a gimmick — but because it forces the room to remember you as a specific person, not a generic set of tracks. The DJs who last all have this. Most working DJs don't.

04 USE THE TOOLS. DON'T BE USED BY THEM.

AI is a genuinely great copilot for the boring parts of the job — library management, harmonic analysis, mashup ideation, cataloguing new releases. Use it there.

THE MOVE: The mistake is letting it make the choices that carry meaning. Track selection. Set flow. The moment to bring the energy up or down. Those are your job. If you outsource them, you're competing directly with the machine — and you'll lose.

SECTION 03**THE MONTHLY RHYTHM.**

None of this works if you only think about it once. Here's the actual weekly practice for building the moves above into your working life.

EVERY WEEK

- Spend 60 minutes discovering music outside your usual genres. Not for your next set — for your taste.
- Write one paragraph publicly about a track, a mix, or a moment. Practice making your reasoning visible.
- Test one new AI tool for 15 minutes. Know what's shipping before it becomes essential.

EVERY MONTH

- Record and re-listen to one full set. Note where you played it safe and where you took a risk.
- Add one new signature edit, transition, or genre bridge to your kit. Something that's yours.
- Ask one working peer for a track they played recently that you'd never have picked. Play it out.

EVERY QUARTER

- Audit your last three months of sets. What connects them? If the answer is nothing, that's the problem.
- Rewrite your public bio around one specific point of view. Not what you play. What you believe about it.
- Book yourself into one room outside your comfort zone. Different city, different scene, different crowd.

THE PRINCIPLE UNDERNEATH

Every hour you spend on technical drills is an hour AI can already do better than you.
Every hour you spend on taste, point of view, and human presence is an hour AI cannot touch. Move your hours accordingly.

THE RHYTHM

None of these are complicated. All of them are the difference between a DJ who lasts through the AI shift and one who doesn't. Screenshot this page and stick it above the setup.

SECTION 04

GO DEEPER.

The interviews, articles, and voices worth tracking as this all unfolds.

THE VOICES WORTH LISTENING TO

INTERVIEWS + STATEMENTS

• **Carl Cox on AI and DJing**[2025 interviews](#)

"I reckon we are all going to disappear and AI is going to take over." The most respected DJ alive is worried. Read what he's doing about it — his live show Evolution is the working answer.

• **Peggy Gou on curation and identity**[Various DJMag / Mixmag features](#)

The clearest working example of a DJ whose value is her point of view — untouchable by any algorithm.

• **Fred Again on making sets feel personal**[Boiler Room, RA podcast interviews](#)

His diary-set approach is the model for irreplaceable DJing. Every set is a specific human moment, not a playlist.

INDUSTRY WATCH

STAY CURRENT

• **Attack Magazine · Resident Advisor · DJ Mag**

The trade press that actually covers AI in DJing honestly, not as hype pieces.

• **CISAC AI music reports**

The industry body tracking how AI-generated music is reshaping the streaming economy. Not fun reading, but real.

• **The tool release notes**

Serato, Algoriddim, VirtualDJ, Rekordbox all ship AI updates quarterly. Read the release notes. That's the ground truth.

THE MACHINE CAN MIX. IT CAN'T MEAN ANYTHING.

That's the whole job now. The DJs still working in five years are the ones who understood this early.

MORE FROM THE RIDER → @THEVICFIX

No.04 — The One-Page Contract. (booking sheet, India + global)

No.05 — Protect Your Ears. (hearing toolkit + earplug brands)

No.06 — Your Brain On DJing. (neuroscience field guide)

No.07 — You're Paid To Put People Back Inside Their Own Memories.

AWARENESS, NOT PROPHECY

The industry is moving fast. Verify current tools and their capabilities before making decisions.